

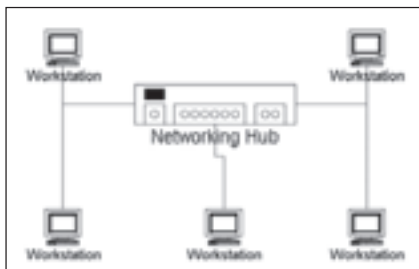
wondered how your cell phone communicates? This chapter will take a term-by-term approach and familiarise you with all the technologies used in the field of communication.

First, we'll start off by explaining different kinds of networks and their uses. Then we'll explain the different technologies such as Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, etc., used for communication and how they work. Moving beyond networks we've also explained how your cell phone communicates and how Global Positioning System, which helps you in navigation, works.

Types of networks

LAN (Local area networks)

This network covers a small area such as a school, office or a building. It's usually set up to share files, internet and printers and to play multi-



Basic LAN structure



WLAN structure

player games. Local area networks are easy to build and maintain. The simplest LAN is two computers connected by an ethernet cable (commonly referred to as "LAN Cable"). Multiple computers can be connected to the LAN using a network hub. Multiplayer games can be played by building a temporary LAN which is commonly called a LAN party.

WLAN (Wireless local area network)

As the name suggests, this network provides the same kind of connectivity as LAN without the cables. It uses radio signals to communicate. Your device must be Wi-Fi enabled to connect to a WLAN.